

Nisarg Patel | નિસર્ગ પટેલ

Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture, University of Southern California
nvpatel@usc.edu | <https://nisargvpatel.github.io> | Updated 11 October 2026

EDUCATION

2021–2027	University of Southern California Ph.D. Candidate, Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture Dissertation: “Enframed: Visual Culture(s) and the Changing Perceptions of History in India (1860–1960)” Committee: Prof. Neetu Khanna, USC (supervisor); Prof. Panivong Norindr, USC; Prof. Vanessa Schwartz, USC; Prof. Priya Jaikumar; Prof. Ronald Mendoza-de Jesús, Emory University. Research areas: South Asia (19 th –21 st centuries); continental theory; vernacular literature; visual studies
2019–2020	University of Toronto M.A., Comparative Literature, with a focus in South Asian Studies; GPA: 3.97/4.0
2016–2019	University of Toronto H.B.A., English Literature (major); Cinema Studies (minor); Literary Theory and Criticism (minor) GPA: 3.74/4.0; Silver Medal
2013–2016	Indira Gandhi Open University B.A., Philosophy; First Class
2012–2016	Gujarat Technological University B.E., Production Engineering; GPA: 8.14/10; High Distinction

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

2025	Ph.D. Academy Certificate in Communication, Leadership, and Management, USC
2024	Visual Studies Graduate Certificate, USC
2024	Center for Excellence in Teaching Certificate, USC
2023	Digital Media and Culture Certificate, USC

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

2026–2027	National Stereoscopic Association Research Fellowship Library of Congress; \$3,000
Summer 2026	USC Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant University of Southern California; \$2,000
2025–2026	Graduate Scholar, Society of Fellows in the Humanities Levan Institute for the Humanities, USC; \$3,000 Teresa Wilson Endowed Fellowship University of Southern California; \$4,000
Summer 2025	Visual Studies Research Institute Summer Research Fellowship Visual Studies Research Institute, USC; \$2,000
2024–2025	Salz Pollak Research Fellowship University of Southern California; \$3,000
Summer 2024	Visual Studies Research Institute Summer Research Fellowship Visual Studies Research Institute, USC; \$2,000 CSLC Summer Research Fellowship Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture, USC; \$1,000
2023–2024	NEH/VSRI “Images out of Time” Graduate Fellow Visual Studies Research Institute, USC
Summer 2023	USC–LACMA Summer Research Fellowship Visual Studies Research Institute and Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture, USC; \$3,000
2022–2023	PhD Academy Scholarship and Research Fund Dornsife PhD Academy, USC; \$500 GSG Professional Development Fund Graduate Student Government, USC; \$500

Summer 2020	Graduate Research Fellowship East Asian Studies, University of Toronto; \$2,000
2019–2020	Center for Comparative Literature Graduate Program Award University of Toronto Writers-in-Residence Fellowship for Creative Writing Massey College, University of Toronto
2018–2019	Undergraduate Research Fellowship Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto; \$1,000

PUBLICATIONS

Book Chapter

“Nationalist Ideology in the Times of Transnational Cinema.” In *Theorizing Cinema’s Multiple Globalization*, edited by Keith Wagner, Seung-Hoon Jeong, and Meta Mazaj. Routledge, forthcoming February 2027.

Articles

“Dreams, Delirium, and Other Postcolonial Passions.” *The Last DVD*, 11 October 2026.

“Ancient Myths, National(ist) Bestsellers.” *Mid-Theory Collective. Mid-Theory Review*, 8 October 2026.

“Between Two Deaths: The Work of Silence in the Thought of Ranajit Guha and Gayatri Spivak.” *OLR Supplement*. Online, 27 August 2026.

Book Reviews

“The Other Epics of India: Gurram Jashuva’s ‘Gabbilam’.” *The Hooghly River Review*. Online, 2 February 2026.

“India’s Absent Revolution: On Manu Joseph’s ‘Why the Poor Don’t Kill Us’.” *Raiot Magazine*. Online, 23 January 2026.

“Frontiers, Sovereignty, and the Politics in/of Trieb.” *OLR Supplement*. Online, 5 August 2025.

“Stories in the Time of Despair: Easterine Kire’s ‘Spirit Nights’.” *The Hooghly River Review*. Online, 13 March 2025.

Translations

“Seven Poems in a Train” by Manglesh Dabral. *Harf: A Journal of South Asian Studies*, vol. 5, 2025.

“Simple Sorrows: Five Poems” by Manglesh Dabral. *The Hooghly Review*, online, 30 March 2025.

“Three Poems by Manglesh Dabral.” *Asymptote*, online, 18 March 2025.

“Five Poems” by Manglesh Dabral. *Muse India*, June 2025.

Visual Art

“64 Seconds.” *Locomotive: A Marxian Magazine*. January 2025.

“Abandoned.” *Spectator*. Fall 2022.

AWARDS AND HONORS

2019	Silver Medal for Outstanding Academic Achievement St. Michael’s College, University of Toronto
2018–2019	Dr. Michael Lutsky Undergraduate Award in Humanities St. Michael’s College, University of Toronto
2016–2019	Dean’s List Honoree University of Toronto
2016	Research Award for Outstanding Engineering Project Birla Vishvakarma Mahavidyalaya, Gujarat Technological University; INR 5,000

CONFERENCE AND WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2026–2027	“History, Mythology, and the Everyday in Early Indian Cinema.” Symposium organizer, “Everyday Practices of Media in India.” Annual Conference on South Asia, University of Wisconsin–Madison “Dreams, Delirium, and Other Postcolonial Passions.” First Forum, USC
2025–2026	“Writing After Amnesia: The Narratives of History between G. N. Devy and Qurratulain Hyder.” Seminar organizer, “Uses and Abuses of History in Literary Narratives.”

	American Comparative Literature Association Annual Meeting
	“To See a World in a Frame of an Image: Stereoscopes and Colonial ‘Life-Worlds’ of British India.”
	Annual Conference on South Asia, University of Wisconsin–Madison
	“Between Two Deaths: The Work of Silence in the Thought of Ranajit Guha and Gayatri Spivak.”
	CSLC Annual Graduate Student Symposium, USC
2024–2025	“Visions of Pasts, Fictions of History.”
	Winter Workshop on Photography, Universität Tübingen
	“Witnessing Empire: Stereoscopes and the 1857 Mutiny in British India.”
	Media Fields Journal Biennial IX Conference
2022–2023	“Ancient Myths, Modern Markets.”
	Summer Workshop on South Asian Literature, Universität Tübingen
	“Nationalist Ideologies in the Time of Transnational Cinema.”
	CARGC Symposium, University of Pennsylvania
	“हमारे अपनों को जगाना है: Bollywood’s Histories in the Time of Hindu Nationalism.”
	SAGSC XX, University of Chicago
	“After-Images of Pre-Colonial India.”
	NYU Cinema Studies Conference, New York University
2021–2022	“मेरे पास माँ है: Material and Sentimental Excess in Visual Cultures of Post-Colonial India.”
	First Forum, USC
	“Hello, Hello, Ji: Networks of Sociality and Commodity in Post-Colonial India.”
	Annual Conference on South Asia, University of Wisconsin–Madison
	“Expert Yogis, Impotent Men, Depressed Wives: Social Life of Sexual Tonics in Late Colonial India.”
	CSLC Graduate Symposium, USC
	“Making Space, Indulging Fantasies: Studio Photo in Colonial and Post-Colonial India.”
	Annual South Asian Studies Conference, University of Chicago
2018–2019	“Glimpse of an Old Home: On the Hermeneutics of the Colonial Gaze and the Gaze of Colonial Hermeneutics.”
	Research Fellow Presentation, Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto

ACADEMIC PROGRAMMING

2024–Present	Founder and Organizer , ‘Theory Today’ Working Group, Levan Institute for the Humanities, USC Founded and coordinate an interdisciplinary working group in contemporary theory; organized twenty-three book discussions, seven invited lectures, and two workshops over the span of three academic years; developed partnerships with, and secured funding from, five USC humanities units.
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2023–2024	Fall: On Location: The Place of Literature in Global Culture (COLT 102g) Teaching Assistant; Professor Neetu Khanna, Department of Comparative Literature, USC
2023–2024	Spring: Introduction to Sociology (SOCI 200g) Teaching Assistant; Professor Juliana McGene, Department of Sociology, USC
2022–2023	Fall: On Location: The Place of Literature in Global Culture (COLT 102g) Teaching Assistant; Professor Neetu Khanna, Department of Comparative Literature, USC
2022–2023	Spring: Cultures of Latin America (COLT 250g) Teaching Assistant; Professor Roberto Diaz, Department of Comparative Literature, USC

RESEARCH AND ARCHIVAL EXPERIENCE

2026–2027	Graduate Research Assistant, Visual Studies Research Institute, USC
Summer 2024	Graduate Research Assistant, Professor Kimia Shahi, USC
Summer 2023	Summer Researcher, History of Photography, Britt Salvesen, LACMA
Summer 2020	Graduate Research Assistant, Professor Atsuko Sakaki, University of Toronto

2020 Editorial Assistant, Professor Martin Revermann, University of Toronto
2019–2020 Graduate Research Assistant, Professor Sara Saljoughi, University of Toronto

ACADEMIC AND UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2026–2027 President, Dornsife Graduate Student Association, USC
2025–2026 Mentor, Project EduAccess
Mentor, Asian Institute Mentorship Program, University of Toronto
2024–2025 Humanities Lead, Doctoral Career Lead Network, USC Career Center
Vice President, Dornsife Graduate Student Association, USC
2023–2024 Organizer, CSLC PhD Students Initiative, USC
Graduate Representative for CSLC, Dornsife Graduate Student Association, USC
Mentor, Asian Institute Mentorship Program, University of Toronto
2022–2023 Organizer, CSLC Graduate Symposium, USC; theme: “Thinking, Crisis,” keynote: David Marriott
2021–2022 Organizer, CSLC Graduate Symposium, USC; theme: “Illness,” keynote: Anjuli Raza Kolb
Mentor, Asian Institute Mentorship Program, University of Toronto
2019–2020 Organizer, Center for Comparative Literature Graduate Conference; theme: “Fire”
2017 Organizer, Inaugural Shakespeare Undergraduate Conference, University of Toronto

LANGUAGES

Gujarati Native proficiency
Hindi Native proficiency
English Full professional proficiency
French Intermediate working proficiency

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Comparative Literature Association
Society for Cinema and Media Studies

REFERENCES

Neetu Khanna, Associate Professor of Comparative Literature, USC; neetukha@usc.edu
Panivong Norindr, Associate Professor of Comparative Literature, USC; norindr@college.usc.edu
Vanessa Schwartz, Professor of Art History, USC; vschwartz@usc.edu
Priya Jaikumar, Professor of Cinematic Arts, USC; pjaikumar@cinema.usc.edu
Ronald Mendoza-de Jesús, Associate Professor of Comparative Literature, Emory University; rmendoz@emory.edu

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